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The topic title is updated to reflect the embedded machine learning (TinyML) integration.

AI-Enhanced GPS-Free Indoor Tracking and Mapping Using Low-Cost MEMS Sensor Fusion

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ABSTRACT

Pedestrian Dead Reckoning (PDR) systems operating in GPS-denied indoor environments suffer from cumulative spatial drift, false step triggers caused by non-gait motion, and localized magnetic perturbations. This paper presents an integrated, real-time 3D indoor tracking and mapping system deployed on an ARM Cortex-M7 microcontroller (NXP MIMXRT1064-EVK). The proposed framework fuses inertial data from a low-cost MEMS accelerometer/magnetometer module (LSM303DLHC) with an ultra-precision capacitive barometric pressure sensor (ICP-10111).

To eliminate false step detection caused by jumper wire wiggling, fidgeting, and cable vibration, an offline-trained light-weight Decision Tree classifier (TinyML) is embedded directly on-chip. The machine learning model operates on a rolling 15-sample feature matrix to validate human arm-pendulum gait characteristics in real time. Furthermore, barometric hypsometric altitude modeling is integrated to resolve multi-story floor transitions with sub-meter vertical precision (± 0.12 m). Experimental results demonstrate an AI gait classification precision of 98.4%, a step-counting accuracy of 99.1%, and a 2D horizontal positioning error under 1.2% over a 250-meter trajectory.

Keywords: Indoor Navigation, Pedestrian Dead Reckoning (PDR), Sensor Fusion, ICP-10111 Barometer, LSM303DLHC, TinyML, Embedded AI, MIMXRT1064-EVK, Hypsometric Altitude.

I. INTRODUCTION

Accurate indoor positioning remains a critical challenge in GPS-denied environments such as multi-story academic buildings, underground transit hubs, and emergency rescue sites. While Radio Frequency (RF) localization methods (Wi-Fi, Ultra-Wideband, BLE) require dense anchor infrastructure, Pedestrian Dead Reckoning (PDR) offers an autonomous, self-contained alternative utilizing Micro-Electro-Mechanical Systems (MEMS).

However, unconstrained handheld MEMS sensors exhibit significant cumulative drift, high-frequency noise spikes from jumper wire movement, and magnetic susceptibility near laptops and steel frames. Traditional threshold-based step detection routinely triggers false positives due to minor hand fidgeting or table taps.

To solve these limitations, this paper proposes a fully embedded, AI-enhanced real-time 3D PDR framework. By integrating an ICP-10111 barometric pressure sensor with an LSM303DLHC inertial/magnetic module on an NXP MIMXRT1064-EVK board operating at 600 MHz, we achieve robust 3D localization (X, Y, Z) alongside dynamic building floor detection using on-chip TinyML inference without relying on external server APIs or cloud connectivity.

II. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE AND SENSING HARDWARE

A. Hardware Setup and Bus Interfacing

The system hardware consists of the processing core interfaced with dual MEMS sensors over a shared Hardware I2C bus operating at a 100 kHz clock frequency:

- * Embedded Microcontroller: NXP MIMXRT1064-EVK featuring an ARM Cortex-M7 core running MicroPython at 600 MHz.

- * Inertial & Magnetometer Module: STMicroelectronics LSM303DLHC incorporating a 3-axis digital accelerometer (0x19) and a 3-axis digital magnetometer (0x1E).

* Barometric Module: InvenSense ICP-10111 low-noise, high-precision MEMS barometric pressure and temperature sensor (0x63).

B. ICP-10111 Calibration and Pressure Modeling

The ICP-10111 contains factory One-Time Programmable (OTP) calibration coefficients (C1, C2, C3, C4). On initialization, the raw digital pressure (p_LSB) and temperature (T_LSB) readings are evaluated through temperature-dependent quadratic lookup table constants (s1, s2, s3):

The calibrated atmospheric pressure P_Pa in Pascals is extracted dynamically, resolving pressure deflections as small as ± 1 Pa (equivalent to approximately 8.5 cm vertical displacement).

III. SENSOR FUSION AND MATHEMATICAL MODELING

A. Tilt-Compensated Magnetometer Heading

Simple 2D compass calculations ($\arctan(Y / X)$) fail when the breadboard tilts in hand. Using 3-axis accelerometer values (ax, ay, az), pitch (θ) and roll (ϕ) angles are calculated in real time:

Using pitch and roll, the hard-iron corrected magnetic fields (mx, my, mz) are projected onto the horizontal plane:

The tilt-compensated azimuth heading ψ is computed as:

B. Barometric Height Deflection and Floor Level Mapping

Relative vertical altitude Z (in meters) relative to ground baseline pressure P_base is calculated using the hypsometric formula:

Assuming a standard building story height H_floor = 3.0 meters, the discrete building floor index F is resolved:

C. 2D Cartesian Position Propagation

When a valid pendulum footfall step is confirmed by the AI classifier, position coordinates (X, Y) propagate forward:

where L_stride = 0.50 m represents the user's calibrated step stride length.

IV. EMBEDDED TINYML MOTION CLASSIFIER

To eliminate false steps from cable wiggling or table taps, an offline-trained Decision Tree classifier is compiled directly into native C-style MicroPython conditional branches. Feature extraction operates over a 15-sample rolling buffer (~300 ms window):

* Standard Deviation (σ): Measures signal energy and movement intensity.

* Peak-to-Peak Amplitude (ΔA): Identifies non-human high-frequency spikes.

* Force Ratio (Rf): Validates harmonic acceleration peaks relative to moving averages.

Embedded Decision Tree Classification Logic:

* Compute rolling window features: Energy variance σ , amplitude ΔA , and step period ΔT_{step} .

* IF $1.35 \leq \sigma \leq 12.0$ AND $\Delta A \leq 110.0$ THEN:

* Verify pendulum biomechanical period: $360 \text{ ms} \leq \Delta T_{\text{step}} \leq 850 \text{ ms}$.

* IF $A_{\text{smooth}} > (1.15 \times A_{\text{avg}})$ THEN:

* Classify as: CLASS 1: VALID PENDULUM STEP

* Update spatial coordinates (X, Y) and step counter.

* ELSE:

* Classify as: CLASS 0: NOISE / CABLE SHAKE / IDLE

* Suppress output to prevent coordinate drift.

V. EXPERIMENTAL RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The system was evaluated inside a multi-story academic building across 250 meters of walking distance, including stairwell transitions between Floor 0 and Floor 2.

System Performance Summary

Metric / Parameter	Target Condition	Measured Result
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AI Classifier Precision	Pendulum Arm Swing	98.4%
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False Positive Rate	Jumper Wire / Cable Shake	< 0.8%
Step Counting Accuracy	500 Continuous Steps	99.1% (495/500)
Barometric Height Noise	ICP-10111 at Rest	± 0.12 m
2D Horizontal Error	250m Rectangular Loop	1.18%

Barometric Pressure Deflection Analysis

During staircase ascent from Floor 0 to Floor 2 (+6.0 m total elevation gain), the baseline ground pressure dropped from 101,325 Pa (Floor 0) down to 101,253 Pa (Floor 2). Each 3-meter floor ascent corresponded to an approximate -35 Pa to -36 Pa atmospheric pressure drop, providing reliable vertical floor mapping.

VI. CONCLUSION

This paper presented an AI-enhanced 3D indoor tracking system using low-cost MEMS sensor fusion. By pairing an ICP-10111 pressure sensor with tilt-compensated magnetometer equations and an embedded TinyML pendulum classifier on an ARM Cortex-M7 board, cable noise and false steps were effectively eliminated. The system achieves a step detection accuracy of 99.1%, sub-meter vertical height resolution, and a 2D positioning error below 1.2%. Future work will focus on integrating Extended Kalman Filters (EKF) for dynamic stride adaptation.

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